

THE COMPLETE STEP-BY-STEP SYSTEM

Create Your Own *Comic*

A guided workbook and prompt toolkit for turning any idea into a finished, character-driven comic — with a little help from AI.

Write

Design

Publish

Fillable worksheets

Copy-paste prompts

1

Idea & concept

2

Character bible

3

Story & panels

4

Layout & publish

Created for: _____

by Lili Human

START HERE

Welcome, creator.

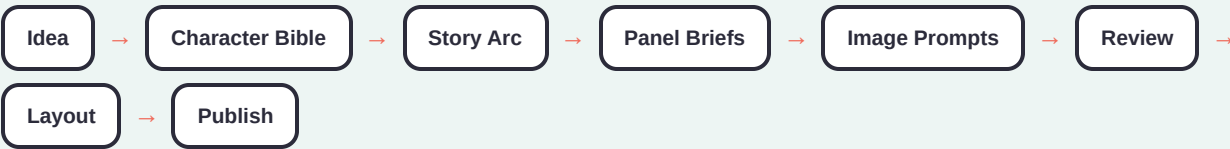
You don't need to draw. You don't need a studio. You need a story worth telling and a system to bring it to life. This workbook is that system — the exact path from a spark of an idea to a finished comic you can print, share, or sell.

Work through it in order the first time. After that, it becomes your reusable template: fill in fresh worksheets for every new character and every new story. The magic isn't the AI — it's the **clear decisions you make before you ever generate a single image.**

THE ONE RULE THAT CHANGES EVERYTHING

Lock your characters **before** you make art. A comic lives or dies on whether your hero looks like the same person in panel 1 and panel 12. Sections 2 and 3 exist entirely to protect that consistency.

THE CORE WORKFLOW



WHAT'S INSIDE

1	Define the Comic Concept	Audience, purpose & tone
2	Build the Character Bible	The heart of consistency
3	Lock the Character Model	Approved reference sheet
4	Plan the Story Arc	7-beat structure
5	Panel Planning Template	One brief per panel
6	Story-Writing Prompts	Copy-paste for Claude / ChatGPT
7	Image-Generation Prompts	Text-free art that stays on-model
8	Panel Review Checklist	Catch problems early
9	Assemble the Comic	Layout & export
10	Series Bible	For recurring stories
11	Product & Sales Planner	Turn it into a product
12	One-Page Quick Start	The whole system at a glance

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Your toolkit

You'll move between three kinds of tools: one to **write**, one to **illustrate**, and one to **lay out** the finished pages. Any tool in each column works — pick what you already know.

TASK	SUGGESTED TOOLS	WHAT YOU'LL GET
Story development	Claude, ChatGPT, or Gemini	Outline & panel-by-panel script
Character planning	Claude or ChatGPT	Character bible & style rules
Illustration	ChatGPT Images, Midjourney, or Adobe Firefly	Text-free panel artwork
Book layout	Canva, Affinity Publisher, or InDesign	Print-ready pages
Publishing	Your website, Amazon KDP, or a local printer	A finished, shareable comic

The five habits of consistent comics

- ☐ Complete the Character Bible *before* generating any artwork.
- ☐ Approve one master character look before making a full series.
- ☐ Write each panel as a *visual brief*, not just dialogue.
- ☐ Generate *text-free* art; add words later in layout.
- ☐ Review every panel for continuity before publishing.

How to use this workbook

Print it, or fill it in digitally with any PDF annotation app. Every dotted line and box is yours to complete.

Sections marked with the **EXAMPLE** badge show a completed sample so you can see what "good" looks like before filling your own.

Keep a blank copy of Sections 2, 5, and 7 — you'll reuse them for every character and every panel.

A NOTE ON THE AI

Treat your writing assistant like a talented collaborator who has never met your characters. The more specific your bible and briefs, the more it feels like **your** comic and less like a generic one. Vague in, vague out.

1

Define the Comic Concept

Every strong comic starts with a clear promise. Answer these before anything else — they steer every decision that follows.

Comic title (a working title is fine)

ONE-SENTENCE PREMISE

This is a story about _____ who wants _____ but must overcome _____.

AUDIENCE & PURPOSE

Target age	
Comic type (single strip, short story, book)	
Main theme or message	
Primary goal (delight, teach, remember, sell)	
Desired length (number of panels or pages)	

TONE WORDS

Choose 3–5 words that describe the finished feeling. e.g. *warm, funny, brave, cozy, wondrous*.

THE FEELING AT THE END

What should the reader feel, learn, or remember when they close the last page?

EXAMPLE CONCEPT

A story about a small dinosaur who wants to reach the top shelf **but must overcome** the belief that being little means being left out. **Tone:** playful, tender, triumphant. **Feeling at the end:** being small is a kind of superpower.

Build the Character Bible

This is the most important page in the book. Fill out one bible for every recurring character. It's the reference you'll paste into every writing and image prompt — the reason your hero stays recognizable in every panel.

Character name

Role in the story

Age or life stage

Species / type (person, animal, creature, object)

VISUAL IDENTITY — THE LOOK THAT MUST NEVER DRIFT

Face shape	
Skin / fur tone	
Eyes (shape & color)	
Hair / fur	
Body proportions	
Signature outfit	
Accessories	
One unique visual trait	

Personality & story function

The inside of your character. Readers fall in love with wants, fears, and flaws — not haircuts.

Three core traits	
What this character wants	
What this character fears	
What makes them lovable	
How they change by the end	
Signature gesture or catchphrase	

APPROVED CHARACTER DESCRIPTION

Write the **exact** visual sentence you will paste into every image prompt. This is the character's "lock."

DO NOT CHANGE

List the features the AI must never alter — the things that make them *them*.

EXAMPLE — FILLED BIBLE

Name: Pip · **Role:** hero · **Type:** small green dinosaur, toddler-aged.

Approved description: "A small round-bellied green dinosaur with big amber eyes, three soft back-spikes, and a red polka-dot scarf. Chubby short arms, wobbly stance, always barefoot."

Do not change: the red polka-dot scarf, three back-spikes, amber eyes. **Wants:** to be big enough to matter. **Catchphrase:** "I can almost reach!"

Lock the Character Model

Before producing the full comic, generate (or commission) an approved reference sheet. This is your "source of truth" — you'll attach it to image prompts so every panel matches.

VIEWS

- ☐ Front view
- ☐ Three-quarter view
- ☐ Side view
- ☐ Back view

EXPRESSIONS

- ☐ Happy
- ☐ Worried
- ☐ Determined
- ☐ Surprised

DETAILS

- ☐ Signature outfit
- ☐ Size comparison
- ☐ Key accessory close-up
- ☐ Turnaround sheet

PRO MOVE

Generate all reference views in **one prompt** on a plain background, then save the best as an attachment. Re-use that same image every time you ask for a new panel — most image tools let you upload a reference so the character stays on-model.

APPROVED REFERENCE — WHERE IT LIVES

Paste, print, or note the file location of your locked reference images here.

Reference A

Reference B

Plan the Story Arc

A satisfying comic has shape: a beginning that sets up, a middle that complicates, and an end that pays off. Map your beats before writing panels — it keeps the story from wandering.

STORY PROMISE

What should the reader feel, learn, or remember at the end?

THE SEVEN BEATS

BEAT	WHAT HAPPENS	MAIN EMOTION	VISUAL OPPORTUNITY
Setup			
Inciting moment			
First attempt			
Complication			
Turning point			
Climax			
Resolution			

EXAMPLE ARC — "PIP & THE TOP SHELF"

Setup: Pip is too short to reach the cookie jar. **Inciting:** everyone else grabs one. **First attempt:** jumping (fails).

Complication: a wobbly stack of books topples. **Turning point:** Pip notices his long tail. **Climax:** he uses his tail as a springboard. **Resolution:** shares cookies with everyone — small, but mighty.

Panel Planning Template

Duplicate this worksheet for every panel. A panel is a single, clear story beat — one moment, one emotion. Plan the picture, not just the words.

Panel number & title

Story function

Setting

Characters present

What happens (one sentence)

Primary emotion

ILLUSTRATION DIRECTION

Camera angle	
Composition	
Character poses	
Facial expressions	
Important props	
Lighting	
Color mood	

TEXT PLAN

Dialogue, narration, or SFX — or leave blank for text-free art.

.....

CONTINUITY CHECK

What must match the panels before & after?

.....

Story-Writing Prompts

Paste these into Claude, ChatGPT, or your assistant of choice. Replace anything in **[BRACKETS]** with your own details from Sections 1–4.

● MASTER STORY PROMPT

You are a professional children's comic writer and visual storyteller.

Create a **[NUMBER]**-panel comic for readers aged **[AGE RANGE]**.

TITLE: **[TITLE]**

MAIN CHARACTER: **[PASTE CHARACTER BIBLE]**

SUPPORTING CHARACTERS: **[PASTE CHARACTER BIBLES]**

THEME: **[THEME]** **SETTING:** **[SETTING]**

STORY GOAL: **[WHAT THE MAIN CHARACTER WANTS]**

CHALLENGE: **[OBSTACLE]**

ENDING MESSAGE: **[LESSON OR EMOTIONAL PAYOFF]**

Requirements: clear beginning, middle, end · one distinct beat per panel · age-appropriate dialogue · humor, warmth & visual action · consistent personalities · vary composition between panels.

For each panel provide: 1) title 2) story function 3) setting 4) character positions & actions 5) facial expressions 6) camera angle & composition 7) lighting & color mood 8) dialogue or narration 9) continuity notes.

● PANEL EXPANSION PROMPT — use after the outline is approved

Expand Panel **[NUMBER]** into a professional illustration brief.

Use the approved character bibles exactly. Do not redesign any character.

Include: detailed environment · camera position & framing · character placement · body language · facial expressions · props & background details · lighting direction · color palette · depth & visual hierarchy · continuity with the previous panel.

Write the brief so an illustrator or image generator can create the scene without guessing.

Image-Generation Prompts

Generate **text-free** artwork — you'll add words later in layout, where you control the fonts. This keeps lettering crisp and lets you translate or edit freely.

● TEXT-FREE ILLUSTRATION PROMPT

Create a **[SQUARE / PORTRAIT / LANDSCAPE]** children's comic illustration.

Use the attached approved character references and this locked bible:

[PASTE CHARACTER BIBLE]

PANEL: **[PASTE PANEL BRIEF]**

ART DIRECTION: **[STYLE] · [LINE QUALITY] · [COLOR PALETTE] · [LIGHTING] · [DETAIL LEVEL]**

· clear emotional storytelling · consistent proportions & facial features · print-friendly composition with safe space for later text.

IMPORTANT: illustration only · NO words, speech bubbles, captions, labels, or logos · do not redesign the characters · do not change signature clothing or accessories.

● COMPACT / MIDJOURNEY FORMULA

[character lock], [action], [setting], [camera angle], [emotion], [lighting],
[palette], children's picture-book illustration, consistent recurring
characters, clean composition, no text --ar [RATIO]

NEGATIVE / AVOID LIST

Features to keep OUT of every image:

.....

.....

.....

IF THE CHARACTER KEEPS DRIFTING

Re-attach your reference sheet, shorten the prompt to the **lock line first**, and add one feature at a time. Over-long prompts dilute the identity — the AI forgets the scarf when it's buried under 200 words.

Panel Review Checklist

Run every generated panel through this before it's "done." Catching a wrong scarf now is free; catching it after layout is a reprint.

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Main character matches the approved face, age, proportions & coloring. | ☐ No accidental text, labels, or distorted lettering. |
| ☐ Signature clothing & accessories are correct. | ☐ Lighting & color fit the emotional beat. |
| ☐ Supporting characters match approved designs. | ☐ Composition differs from adjacent panels. |
| ☐ The panel communicates one clear story beat. | ☐ Important details are inside safe margins. |
| ☐ The emotion reads without dialogue. | ☐ There's usable space for dialogue or narration. |
| ☐ Hands, feet, eyes & props are visually usable. | ☐ Continuity matches the panels before & after. |

REVISION NOTES

What to fix, and how you'll re-prompt for it:

THE 80% RULE

You rarely get a perfect panel first try. Aim for **80% right**, then fix the rest with a targeted re-prompt or a light touch-up in your layout tool. Don't re-roll fifty times chasing perfection.

Assemble the Comic

Bring your text-free panels into a layout tool, add the words, and export. This is where a folder of images becomes a real comic.

THE LAYOUT SEQUENCE

1. Generate text-free illustrations.
2. Choose one page size & orientation.
3. Place images into your layout tool.
4. Add narration & dialogue in readable fonts.
5. Keep all text inside safe margins.
6. Use consistent bubbles & caption styles.
7. Export a review PDF.
8. Proofread & inspect every page.
9. Export the final web or print file.

PAGE & TEXT DECISIONS

Trim / page size	
Bleed	
Orientation	
Title font	
Dialogue font	
Caption style	
Bubble style	
Page-number style	

PRINT VS. SCREEN

For print, work at **300 DPI** with a small bleed and keep important art away from the trim edge. For web, **72–150 DPI** is plenty and files stay light. Decide which one **first** — it changes your page size.

Series Bible

Planning more than one story with the same characters? A series bible keeps every future comic consistent — the rules that never change, no matter who's writing.

Series title	
Series promise	
Target reader	
Recurring themes	
Core cast	
Recurring locations	
Visual style	
Signature palette	
Recurring jokes or motifs	
Hidden-object / running gag system	
Rules that must never change	

WHY A SERIES BIBLE PAYS OFF

Recurring characters build an audience. A hidden motif in every issue (a lost sock, a curious bird) gives fans something to hunt for — and gives you a reason for them to come back.



Product & Sales Planner

Ready to sell? Plan the offer before you build it. Clarity on *who it's for* and *what they get* is half the sale.

Product name

Format (PDF, print, bundle)

What the customer receives	
Ideal customer	
Where you'll sell it	
Price	

PRODUCT DESCRIPTION DRAFT

The words that sell it — the transformation, not just the features.

USAGE & LICENSE NOTES

Add your own terms: personal use, commercial use, redistribution, and whether buyers may sell comics they create.

PRICING STARTING POINTS

A single finished comic sells differently than a **reusable template or workbook**. Templates command more because buyers use them again and again. Bundle a workbook + example comic + prompt pack for your best margin.

One-Page Quick Start

The whole system at a glance. Once you know the flow, this is the only page you'll need.

STEP	ACTION	DONE
1	Choose a story idea & write the one-sentence premise	☐
2	Complete character bibles for every recurring character	☐
3	Lock approved reference images	☐
4	Generate the panel outline with the Master Story Prompt	☐
5	Expand each panel into an illustration brief	☐
6	Generate text-free art with the Image Prompt	☐
7	Review every panel & revise	☐
8	Lay out, add text, proofread & export	☐



Strong comics aren't drawn. They're decided.

Clear character rules, visual planning, consistent references, careful review, and intentional revision. Do those five things and the tools will follow. Now go make something your readers will remember.

Lili Human

Made something with this workbook? I'd love to see it.